

HAIYI YU

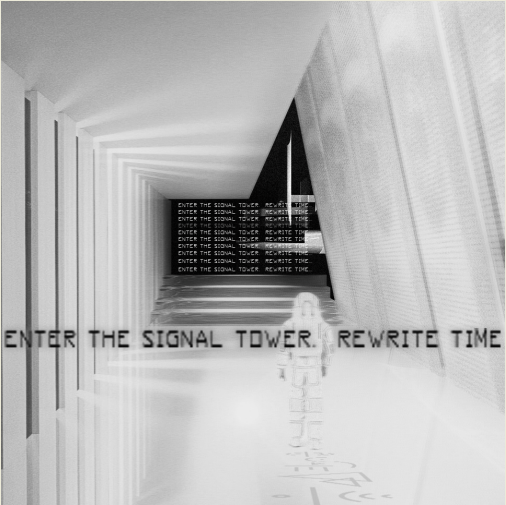
DESIGN WORKS

PORTFOLIO

RMIT

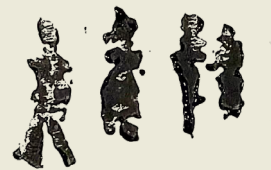
INTERIOR DESIGN

A BOOK ABOUT
FEATURING WORKS
2023 TO ME
FROM 2025



My work explores interiors as narratives — spaces that tell stories through fragments, memory, and material reuse. Trained at RMIT, I approach design as both a critical and poetic practice, where **adaptive reuse** becomes a way to bridge the past and present, while **imagining future possibilities** for **public space**.

Each project in this collection reflects my interest in narrative expression and material honesty: from speculative installations to adaptive reuse proposals, I seek to reveal how design can **transform** overlooked materials, forgotten sites, and everyday experiences into meaningful spatial encounters. Working between Melbourne and Beijing, I aim to **integrate cultural** context with experimental methods, producing interiors that are both **locally grounded and globally resonant**.



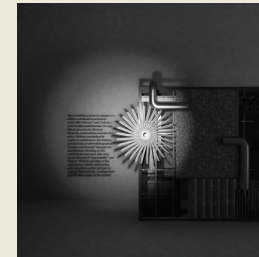
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Across cultures
& spaces
between
day&night



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INTERLUDE
Between memory
and silence



3
DIALOGUE
Across time and
space



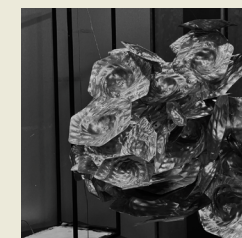
4
PERCEPTION
Evolving city
landscapes



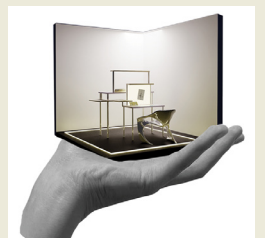
To create narrative-driven spaces that embrace adaptive reuse and material honesty, transforming fragments of the past into meaningful experiences for the present and future.

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INTERSECTION

ACROSS CULTURES & SPACES
BETWEEN DAY & NIGHT



Izakaya & Bar

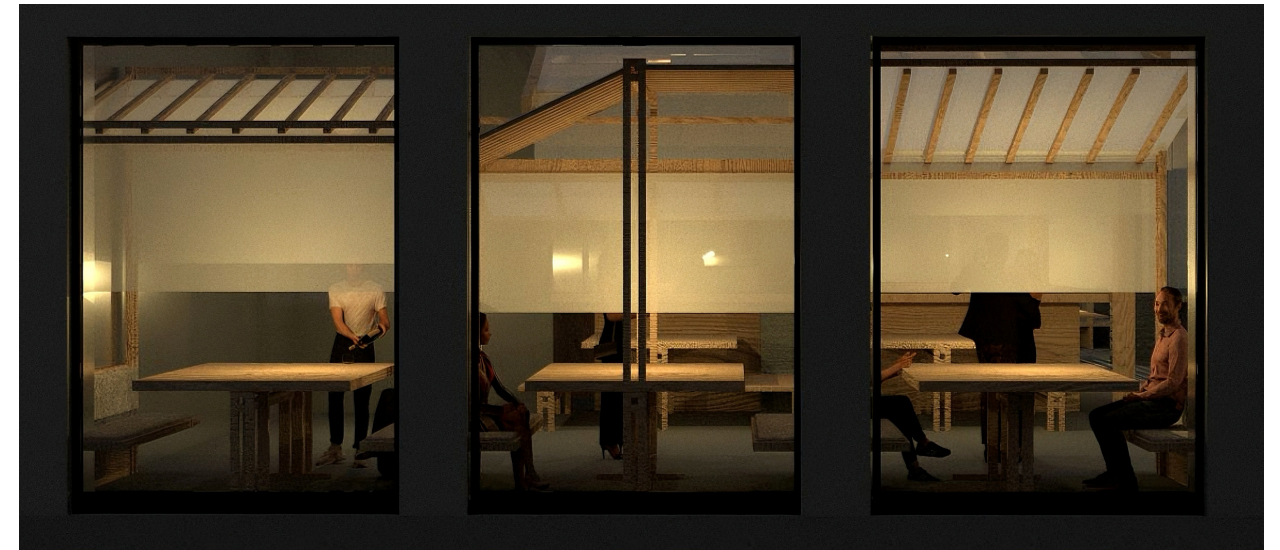
My proposal reimagines the diner as a space of dual identities. By day, it opens as a bright izakaya-inspired cafe, filled with natural light and warm tones. By night, it transforms into a neon-lit futuristic bar, offering an entirely different atmosphere. This contrast is designed to attract young adults seeking both relaxation and connection, creating a memorable experience that encourages return visits.



A compact bubble tea bar anchors the entry sequence, introducing a casual and welcoming atmosphere while connecting directly to the street.



Exploded axonometric drawing of the overall project, showing the layered program: tea shop, open kitchen, dining booths, stage, and an “Instagrammable” social space. The diagram highlights how modular elements and spatial zoning create both intimacy and collective vibrancy.



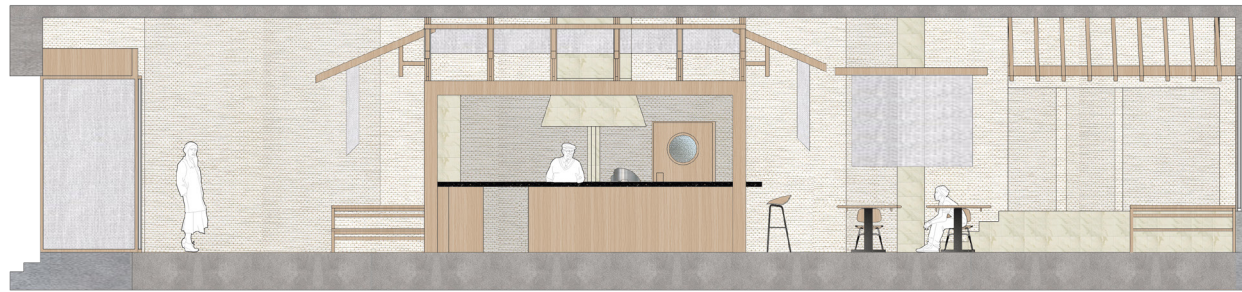
This side faces the booth area, where curtains can be drawn during the day to create a quiet and private atmosphere, ideal for meetings and small gatherings. At night, the space transforms into a more open bar setting, with lighting and canopy structures shaping a vibrant scene. The design achieves a transition from izakaya to bar, enabling the space to embody versatility across different times of use.

DAY TO NIGHT LIGHTING CHANGES

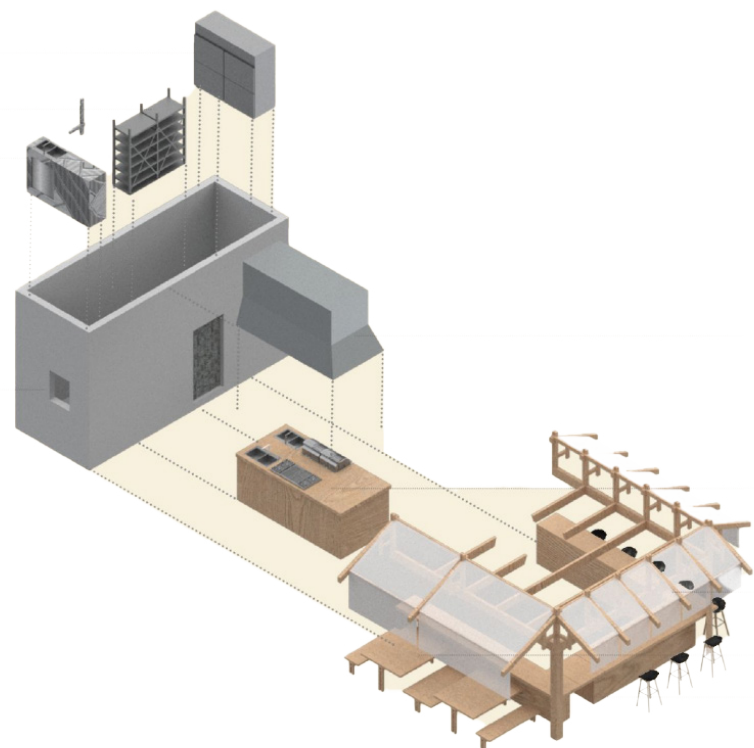




An exploded view of the booth structure, showing the timber frame, canopy, and shoji-inspired partitions that create semi-private dining spaces.



Section Drawing



Exploded diagram of the back kitchen and bar area.

Shows the integration of storage space, kitchen workstation, and communal dining area.

This is a collage about the overall style of the restaurant.

At the center, the kitchen and island counter operate as an omakase bar during the day and transform into a cocktail station at night. On the right side, the stage and shared dining area feature a dry garden-inspired floor texture, including an “Instagrammable” spot for visitors. Along the street side, semi-private dining booths are provided: by day, curtains can be lowered to create intimate spaces for conversation, while at night the booths open up to connect with the rest of the bar, enhancing spatial interaction.



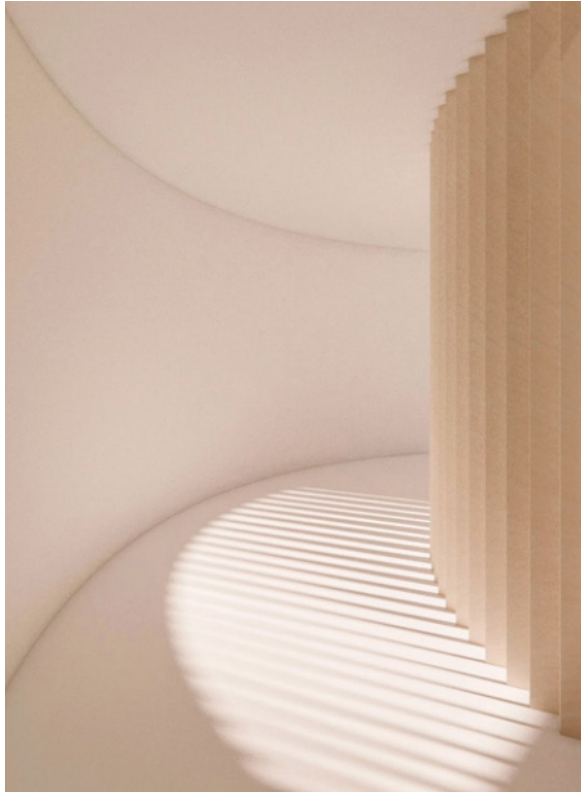
INTERLUDE

BETWEEN MEMORY AND SILENCE



ABODE OF SIMPLICITY

This project unfolds from an antique fan, whose pleated form and fleeting shadows inspired spatial gestures. Corridors echo its folds, casting light like fan blades across curved walls. Curtains and thresholds dissolve into fluid transitions, reimagining boundaries. What began as a small object becomes a spatial narrative—a pause within the city, where memory and atmosphere quietly intertwine.



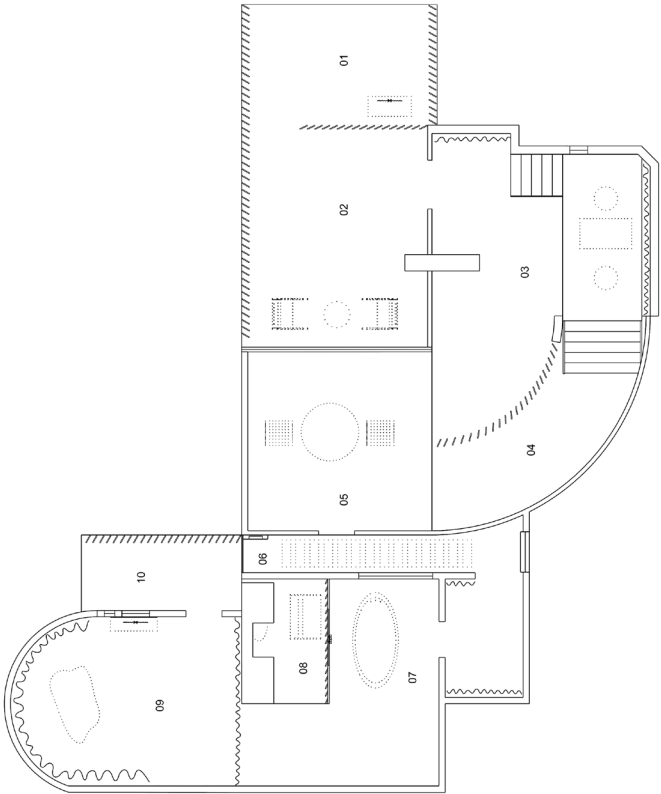
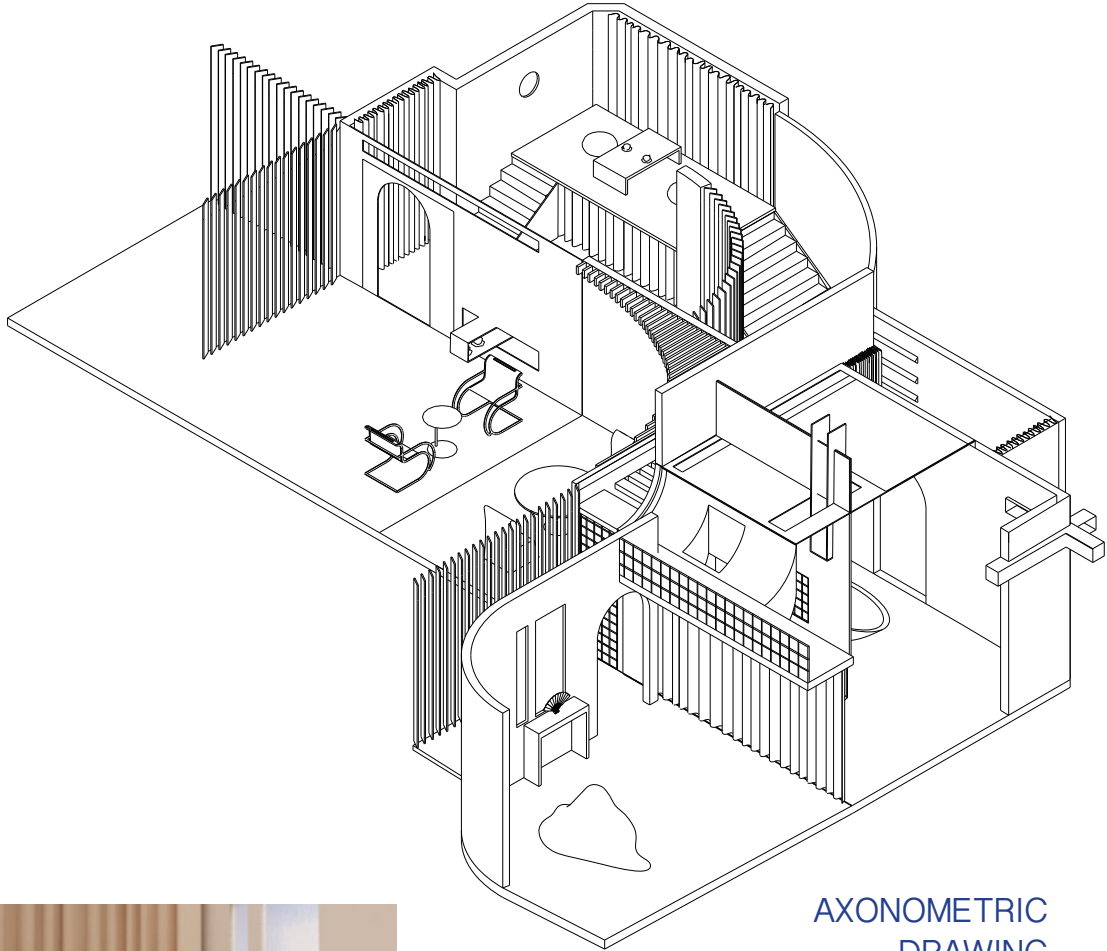
The folding form of the fan is expressed within the space



By re-collaging and inverting interior elements, I was able to reimagine the possibilities of spatial design—no longer a conventional interior, but a new context generated through the rotation and reassembly of the previous space. Doors, windows, and partitions are stripped of their traditional functions and reinterpreted as mediators that redefine boundaries and fluidity. This approach became an important source of inspiration for Project 4.



FLOOR PLAN



GROUND FLOOR PLAN
SCALE: 1:75@A2

06 THRESHOLD
07 BATHROOM
08 DRESSING ROOM
09 THEATRE
10 EXIT

01 ENTRANCE
02 FRONTYARD
03 TEA ROOM
04 HALLWAY
05 DINING ROOM

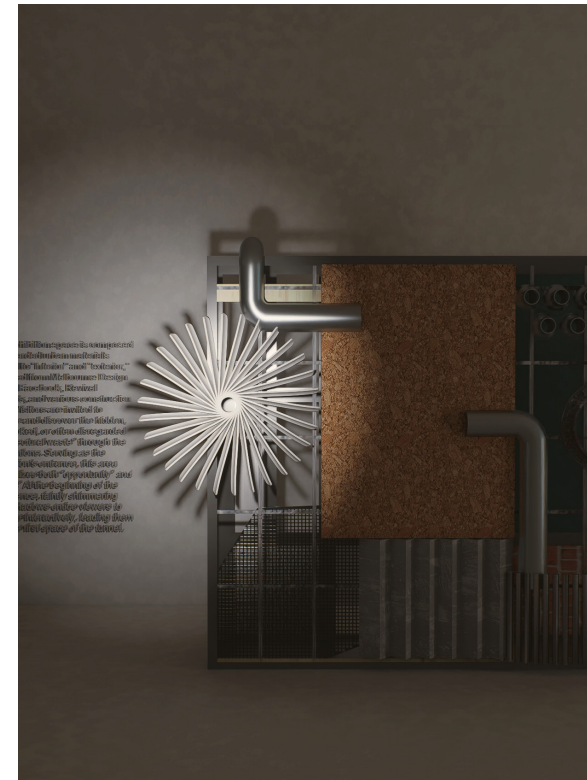


DIALOGUE

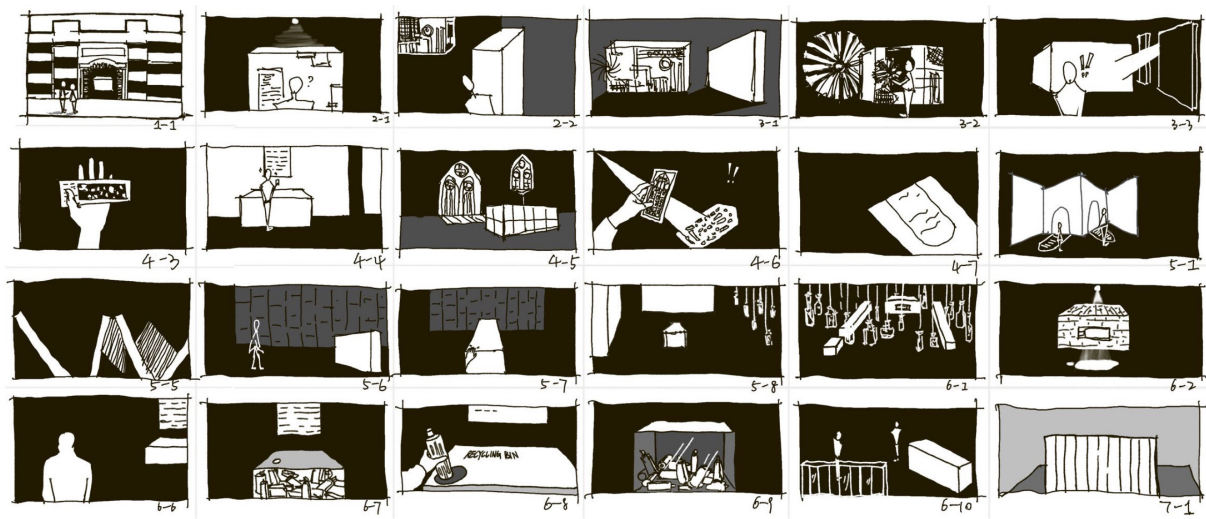
ACROSS TIME AND SPACE

ENDLESS LIFE

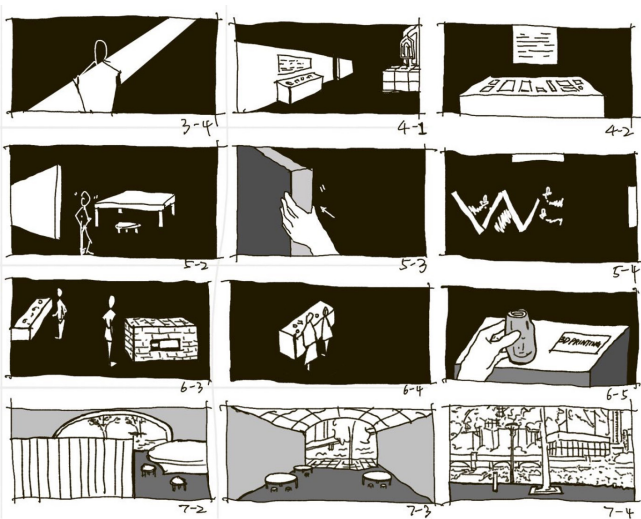
This project aims to adaptively reuse the Banana Alley Vaults, a heritage site located between the Birrarung River and Flinders Street, transforming it into a public pedestrian passage and art space. Adhering to the Victorian Heritage Conservation Law, the design utilizes recycled materials, including red brick, traditional lime mortar, stone, and construction waste from modern buildings, to preserve the site's original character while promoting sustainability. The design concept is rooted in creating a dialogue between the old and the new by juxtaposing historic elements with modern urban materials, such as stained glass embedded in concrete and brick structures. This contrast invites viewers to reflect on the layered history and evolving identity of the city.



STORYBOARD



This storyboard maps the visitor’s journey through the exhibition, where each interaction with installations reveals the material’s unique qualities. By engaging with recycled products and their re-creation, the exhibition evolves into a temporary maker space—an environment of experimentation and collective making. At the same time, the art corridor functions as a public passage that connects the interior space with the Yarra River, extending the dialogue between material reuse and the city’s cultural landscape.



PARTIAL DETAIL DISPLAY

The entrance installation is built from recycled urban waste materials, introducing the narrative of the corridor. Light emanates from within the structure, projecting dynamic patterns onto the ground and guiding visitors into the space.



SECTION RENDER



In this installation, recycled industrial materials support a Gothic-style stained-glass frame, where light transforms the object into both structure and memory. The projection on the wall blurs the line between past and present, material and immaterial, extending the project's theme of dialogue across time and space.



Discarded bricks and stones are reassembled into partition walls that function not only as spatial dividers but also as “strata of history” to be reinterpreted. At the same time, abandoned exhibition stands and leftover components collected from Melbourne Design Week are transformed into spatial installations, creating a layered interplay of material and memory.



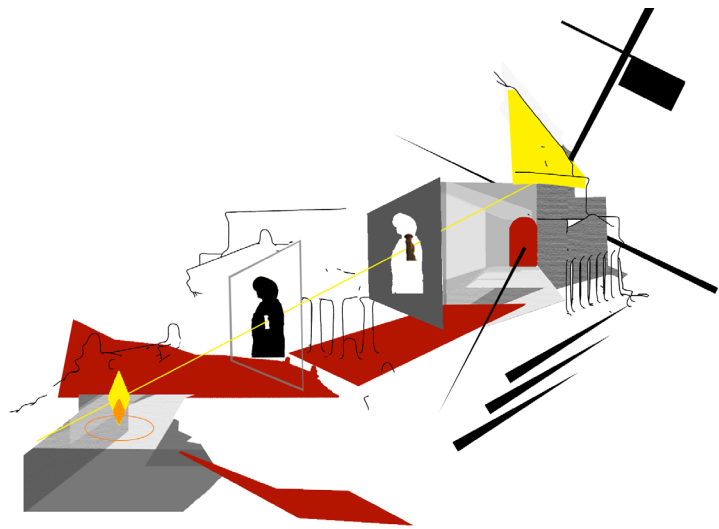
A table and lighting installation made from discarded materials. The reused transparent support and reclaimed wooden surface embody the project's ethos of renewal, transforming waste into a functional and poetic furniture piece.



A discarded plastic bottle, found along the Yarra River, is reimagined as part of the installation. Its fragile transparency refracts light, turning everyday waste into a fragment of narrative—connecting memory, material, and regeneration.

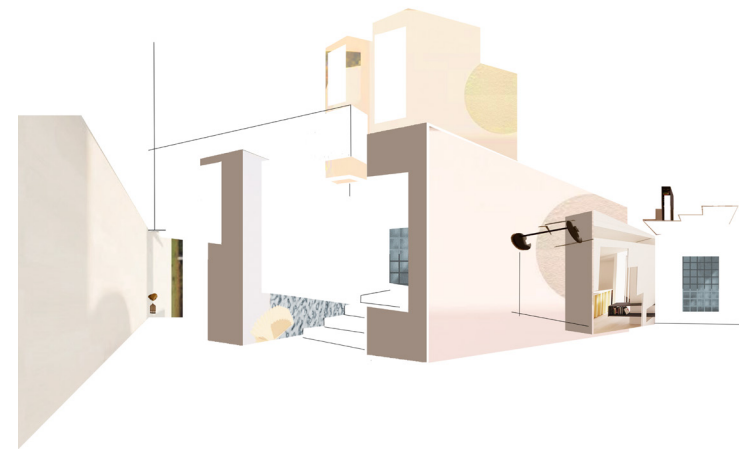
PERCEPTION

BETWEEN THE EVOLVING CITY LANDSCAPES



COLLAGE MY SIGHT

A fire altar marks the pioneers' sacrifice—fire as life, fire as memory. Through the gate, soldiers shift from black to white, from body to spirit, guided toward the roof's light. At the end, a flag and cross-shaped triangle hold both peace and conflict in one frame.

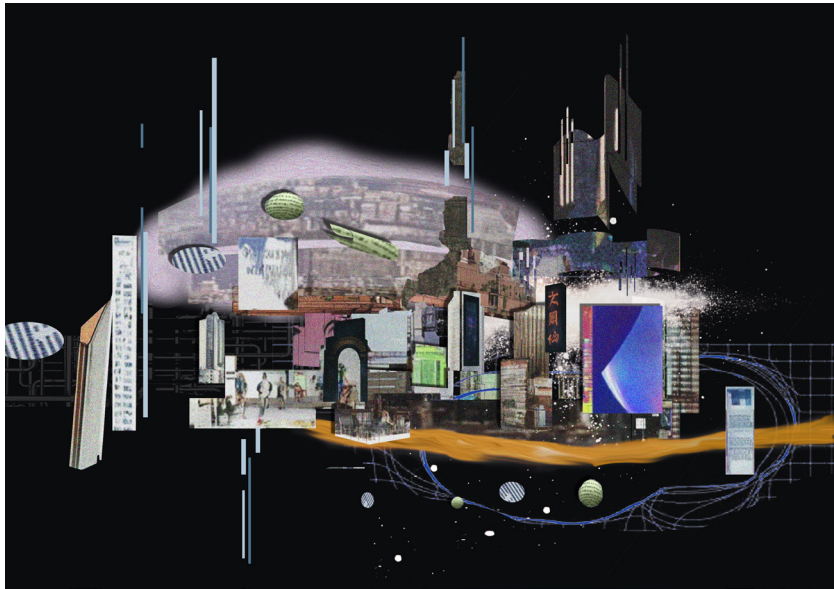


COLLAGE MY PREVIOUS DESIGN

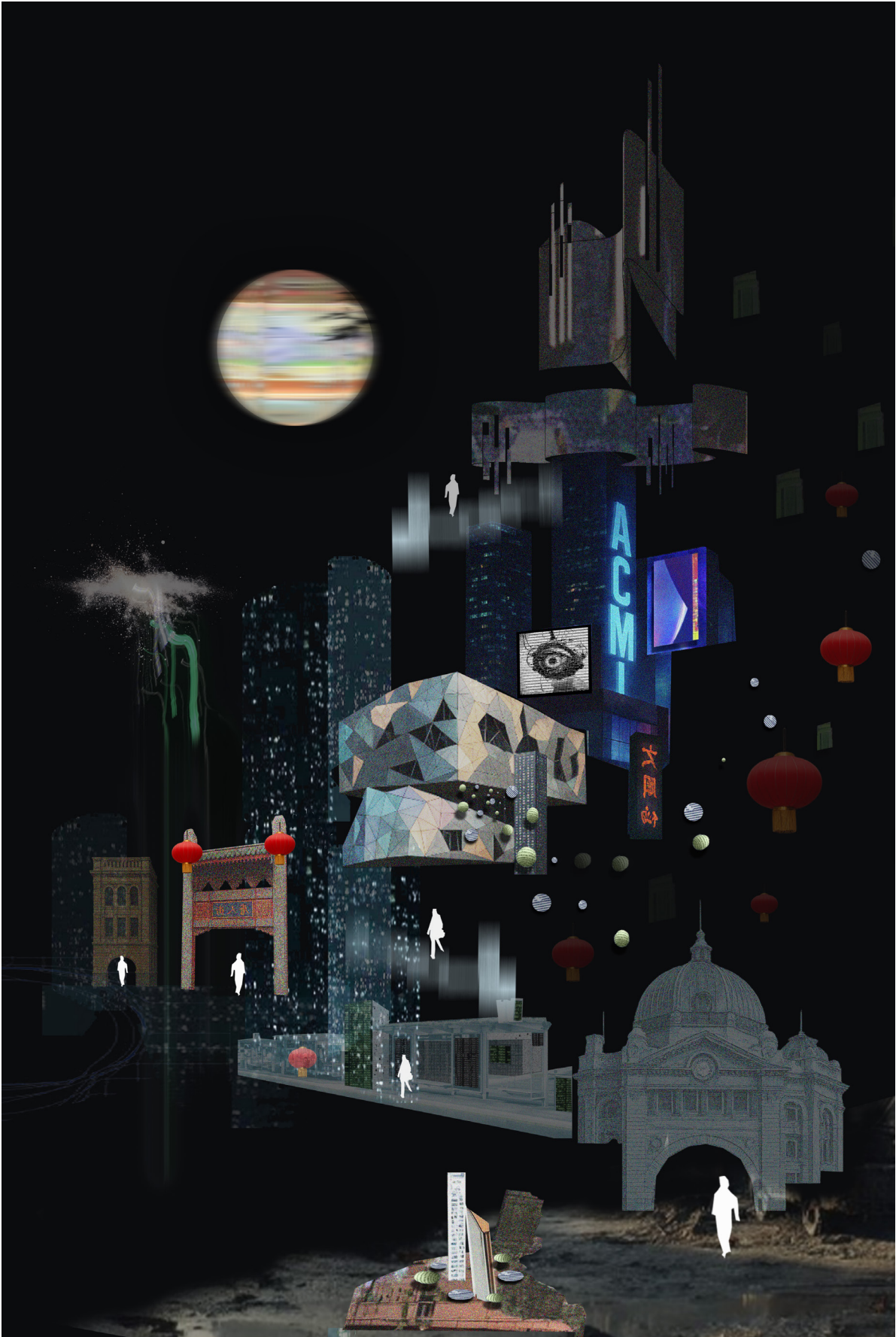
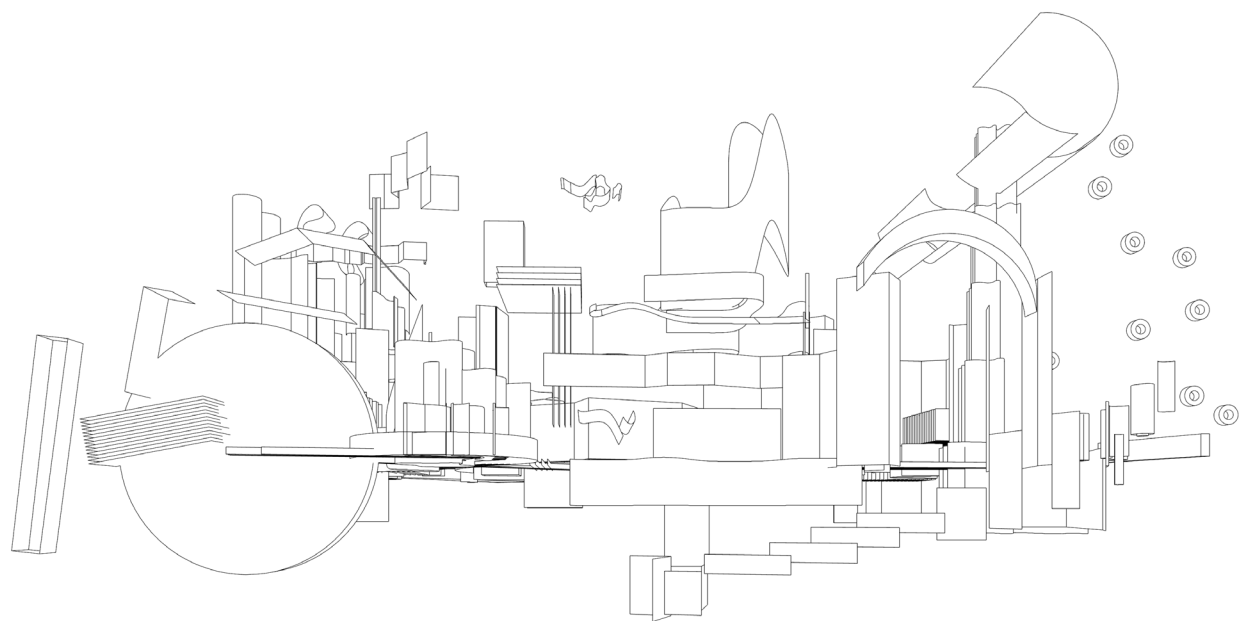
A residence born from three originals—Modernist at heart, yet flipped in form. Walls become entrances, thresholds become spaces. Logic inverted, but the feeling remains familiar.

PREVIOUS SUMMARY

The two collages above are the results of my observations on how space transforms from a fixed form into personal perception. These works inspired me to explore how the city evolves into a fluid, evolving city landscape. The final outcome consists of two posters that reconstruct the worldview of Melbourne, inviting people into a future urban space reimagined by me.



Based on the line drawing below (derived from a floor plan that I abstracted), I re-collaged imagined urban elements and possible city structures, incorporating digital symbols, cloud data, ruins, and skyscrapers. Drawing inspiration from the style of the film “Blade Runner 1982”, I created my own vision of Melbourne as a future city.





FORMATION

FROM PATTERN TO SPATIAL DEPTH

01 FUTURE PARTITION

A project exploring how scanned natural forms and AI-generated morph patterns can be transformed into three-dimensional partitions. Through iterative layering and aggregation, the work shifts from 2.5D surfaces to volumetric assemblies. I contributed by designing the morph patterns and programming workflows, enabling the partitions to combine spatial rhythm, depth, and shadow.

02 CANTILEVERED SWIVEL CHAIR

This project explores a cantilevered swivel chair driven by a gear-based rotation mechanism, realised through the combined use of bent veneer lamination and digital fabrication. Veneer is not treated as a surface finish but as a structural material that actively participates in load-bearing and motion control. The integration of material behaviour and mechanical logic forms a lightweight yet stable self-supporting structure, where structure itself becomes the mechanism of movement.



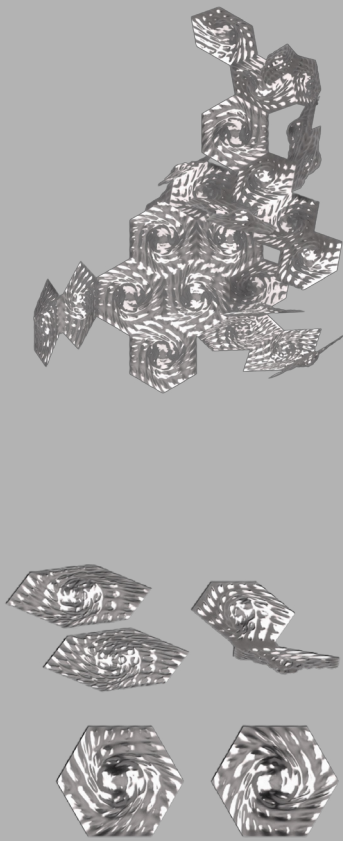


INCREMENTAL SHEET FORMING TEST PANEL

Process of work

- site investigation
- narrative (midjourney pattern)
- programming (grasshopper — morph/aggregation /wasp)
- 3d scanning
- incremental sheet forming (isf) test
- physical model welding
- documentation&rendering

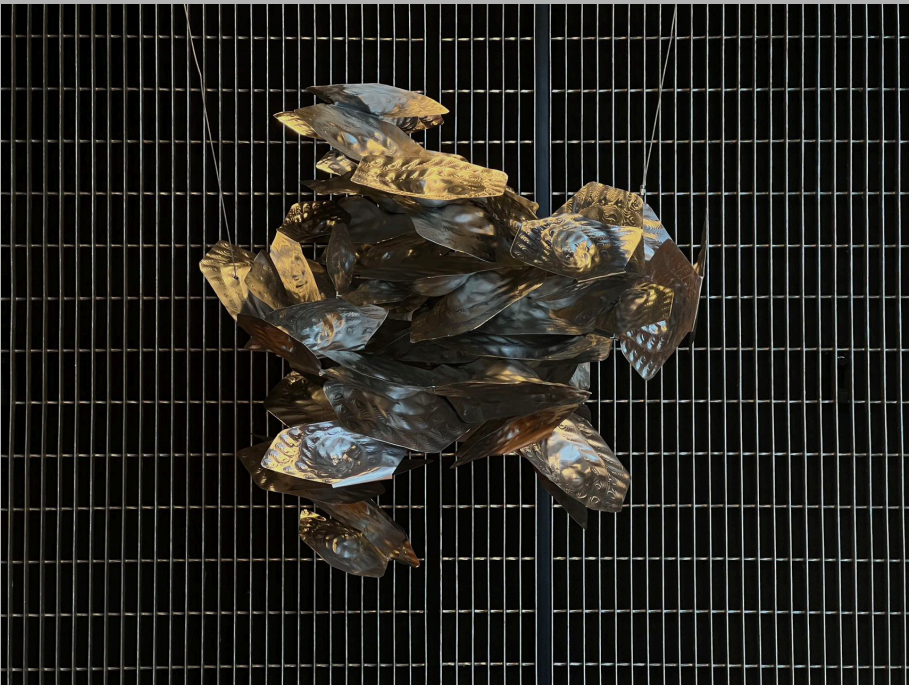
DIGITAL MODEL



FINAL RENDER



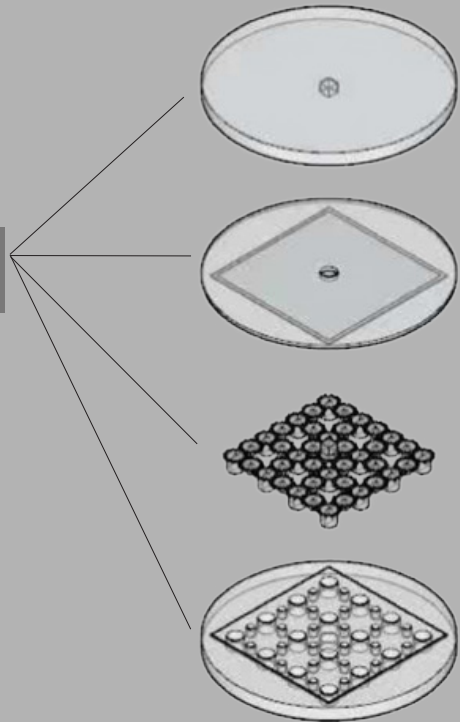
PHYSICAL MODEL



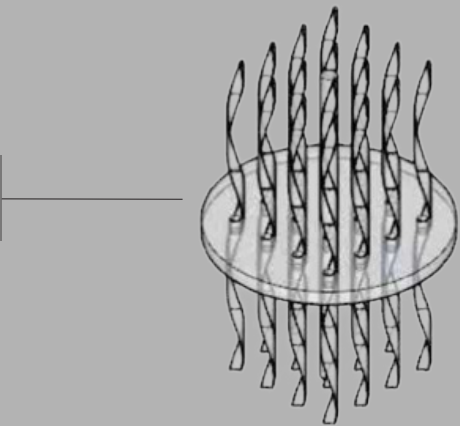
FORMATION 02

CANTILEVERED SWIVEL CHAIR

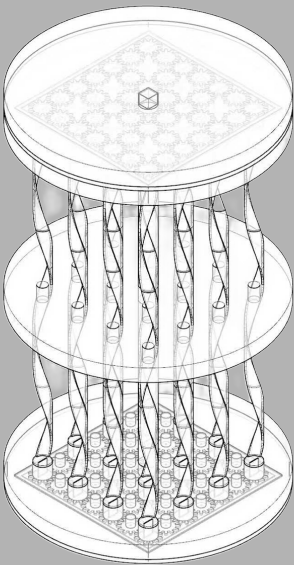
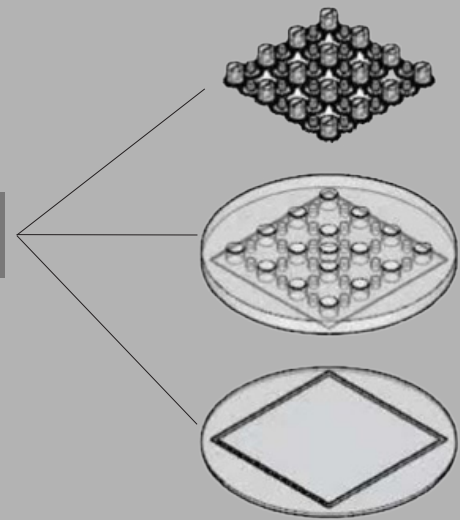
upper layer:
When a person rotates, the central gear drives the surrounding gears to turn.



middle layer:
The gears drive the veneer to rotate, and a rotatable connector between the two veneer layers is used to fix their position and link the upper and lower structures.



lower layer:
The gear structure separates the veneer from the base surface.



3D PRINTING GEARS

DUAL USE OF BENT LAMINATION & DIGITAL FABRICATION



VENEER AS THE BEARING STRUCTURE



SPECULATION

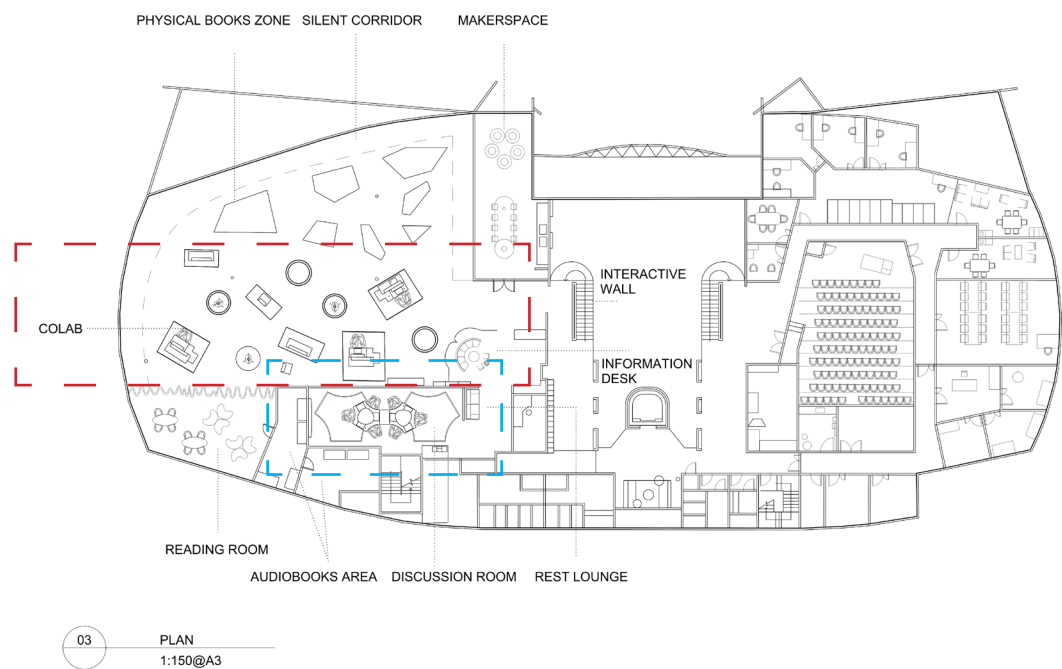
KNOWLEDGE CIRCULATION IN FUTURE LIBRARY

CoLab

This project reimagines the future library as a platform for immersive, interactive, and collaborative knowledge transformation. Aimed at RMIT Fashion and Textiles students, the design unfolds through four phases: Invite, Input, Transfer, and Output as Input. In the CoLab zone, users co-style virtual garments on shared mannequins, turning individual insight into collective creativity. A responsive discussion room supports reflection and archiving. Together, these elements form a regenerative loop—where input becomes output and output sparks new inquiry—making the library an evolving ecosystem of curiosity and imagination.



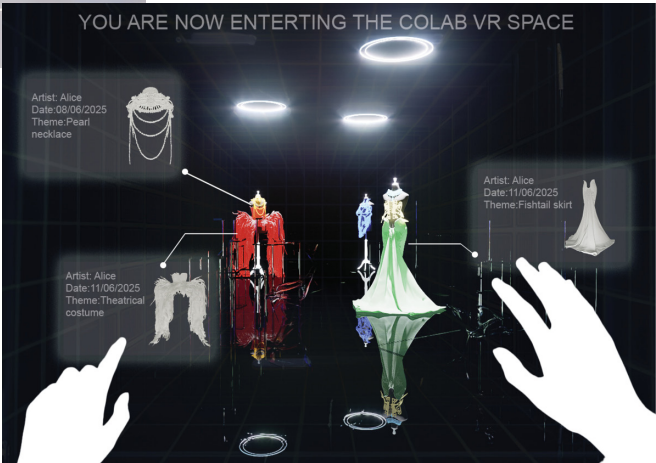
PROPOSED FLOORPLAN



COLAB

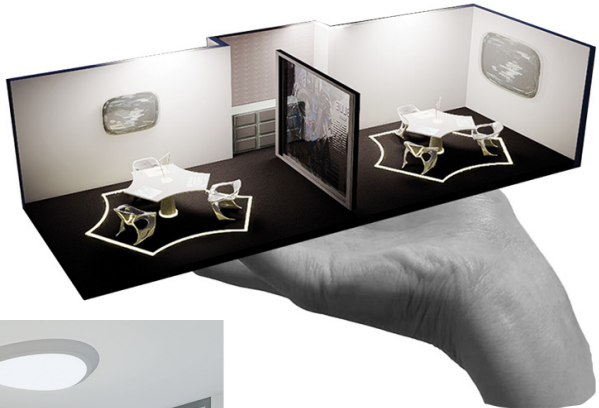


Furniture in this area supports multiple postures—standing, sitting, squatting—making the body part of the thinking process. Each desk contains a drawing board, and once uploaded, your work is visualized in real time on a VR mannequin. You can co-style a design with nearby users—creating collaboratively on different parts: headpiece, top, bottom, shoes. This is not just a creative action, but a moment of knowledge exchange and shared authorship.



DISCUSSION ROOM

This is a flexible space. When separated, it suits small groups discussion. When merged, the walls transform into information displays. Here, you can respond to a keyword previously illuminated by the Interactive Wall. This keyword might be a question, a theme, or a material—serving as a creative anchor. Your response, once uploaded, contributes to a growing Visual Knowledge Archive.



PERSPECTIVE SECTION





stay curious.
stay focused.
stay professional.
still in progress.